Records Management Procedure

Purpose

This procedure tells staff where records are kept, how they are named and when they are destroyed.

Where to keep records

Official records are kept in the document management system or in the departmental folder on the shared drive. Customer files are never kept on a personal drive, a desktop or a phone. Scanned customer documents go into the customer's file in the core banking system.

Naming

Name a file with the department, the title, the version and the date. Example: Claims_Settlement_Letter_v02_2026-03-14. A final version is saved as PDF.

Versions

When a document is replaced, move the old version to the Archive folder of the same department and write the replacement date in the document properties. Do not leave two versions in the same folder.

Destruction

Records are destroyed according to the Data Retention Schedule. The records owner signs the destruction list each year in April.

Scanned records

A paper record that is scanned for the file is scanned at 300 dots per inch in black and white or grey. The scan is saved as PDF with the customer number in the file name. The paper original is kept for 12 months after scanning in the branch records room and is then destroyed, unless the law requires the original.

Shared drives

Each department has one folder tree on the shared drive. The head of department names a folder owner. The folder owner removes access for leavers each month, deletes duplicate files and moves replaced documents to the Archive folder. Folders with no owner are reported to Legal and Compliance every quarter.

Email

Email is not a records system. A staff member who receives a decision, an approval or a customer instruction by email saves it to the customer's file or to the departmental folder the same day. Mailboxes are archived after 12 months and deleted after five years.

Legal holds

When Legal and Compliance places a hold on a record, nobody destroys it, even if the retention period has ended. The hold stays until Legal and Compliance releases it in writing. The records owner keeps a list of the records under hold.

Audit

Internal Audit tests records management once a year. The test covers naming, location, destruction lists and the Archive folder. The results go to the Audit Committee.